

Climate Migration in Colombia

Spring 2024 SEED x FinMango Deliverable

Meet the Team



JP Hoffman

Econ & Commerce

Orlando, FL



Lucy Orr

Econ & Statistics

Decatur, AL



Ivan Gupta

Econ & Pre-Commerce

Ridgefield, CT



Justine Karp

Commerce

Scarsdale, NY

Agenda

Project Overview

Key Findings

Case Study: Bogotá

Solutions

Project Overview

Background + Task

FinMango is a non-profit financial literacy, security, and stability organization, focusing on the migration issues in under-funded policy zones, especially those forced by climate change.

We were tasked with creating a report on **climate policy issues facing South America**. Specifically, we targeted climate change issues in Colombia that drive migration within and away from the region.



Key Findings

5 Key Climate Issues



Drought



Flooding



Weather



Politics



Resources

4 Key Migration Considerations

1.

Migration is not a spontaneous decision

2.

Food insecurity and income are two main drivers

3.

Internal migration occurs before external migration

4.

Migration demographics direct policy solutions

Case Study: Bogotá

Process

Initial Research

- Academic research
- UN and NGO data
- El Tiempo news

Persona & Academia Interviews

- On the ground experience
- Academic insights

Determine Key Issues

- Drought
- Flooding
- Weather
- Politics
- Resources

Three Former Bogotá Residents



Emilia

2nd Year at UVA



Pablo

4th Year at UVA



Antonio

3rd Year at UVA

Three UVA Academics



Nazli Azergun

PhD Candidate
in Anthropology
Research: ESG and
Impact Investing



Jonathan Colmer

Economics Professor
Research: Economics
of Climate Change



David Leblang

Public Policy Professor
Research: Central
American Migration

01 Drought

Water rationing in Bogotá

Emilia

- Government has begun **rotating periodic shutoffs** to limit water usage
- Crisis exacerbated by **population increase** due to internal migration and immigrants from Venezuela

Pablo

- Cattle industry has been deeply affected due to dependency on grass, which requires rain
- Businesses have suffered due to lack of water in the Savannah of Bogota



“Months and months of rain are needed” for reservoirs to recover

- Mayor of Bogotá



02 Flooding

Water is still present, but in the wrong places

Emilia

- Large rivers in the area outside the city flood very often
- Story of a woman whose family lived near Bogota
- A river overflowed during heavy rain, **flooding their house** and resulting in the **death of three family members**.
- The woman now lives with Emilia's grandparents

Antonio

- “When I was a kid, we had a beach in front of the house, and I played in front of the beach.
Nowadays, there's no beach”
- Put cement barriers up to limit water encroachment

03 Weather

Weather is getting more unpredictable

Antonio

- Significant fires led to school closures
- Nobody wears ruanas (traditional Colombian sweaters) anymore

Pablo

- Weather is generally getting warmer, which is problematic for **agricultural diseases**
- New fertilizers are much **more expensive** and increase prices for consumers

The at-risk coffee industry is driving migration



Coffee Rust

- Diseased plants cause decreased agricultural output
- Seasonal workers from other areas are stuck, or migrate north

04 Politics

Corruption is a common thread

Emilia

- Has noticed misuse of monetary resources, such as aid from foreign countries
- The mayor is doing well, but the president is not effectively addressing these issues

Pablo

- “The corruption problem is persistent and very evident”
- More talk than action
- Consider themselves populists but are not popular with the people
- Not realistic with environmental goals

57%

Percent of Colombians that disagree with
President Petro's Constituent

Extreme discontent with national government

April 21st, 2024:

“More than a million marched in Bogotá against President Petro.”

“Massive. Historic. Civic. Peaceful.”



Fallout from 2016 peace treaty

- Land allotments to thousands of displaced peasants
- This led to land conflicts – around 1000 peasant leaders killed since 2016
- ~80% of homicides are of social leaders in rural areas
- Government ignored requests for protection measures

05 Resources

Tensions exist between growth and resource use

Emilia

- Reports of natural resources being stolen or misappropriated.
- Population is pressuring the city's infrastructure, leading to issues with traffic, healthcare, and more.

Pablo

- Concerns over the economic impact of environmental policies, such as halting oil exploration.
- The community is feeling the strain of resource shortages, impacting daily life and business operations.

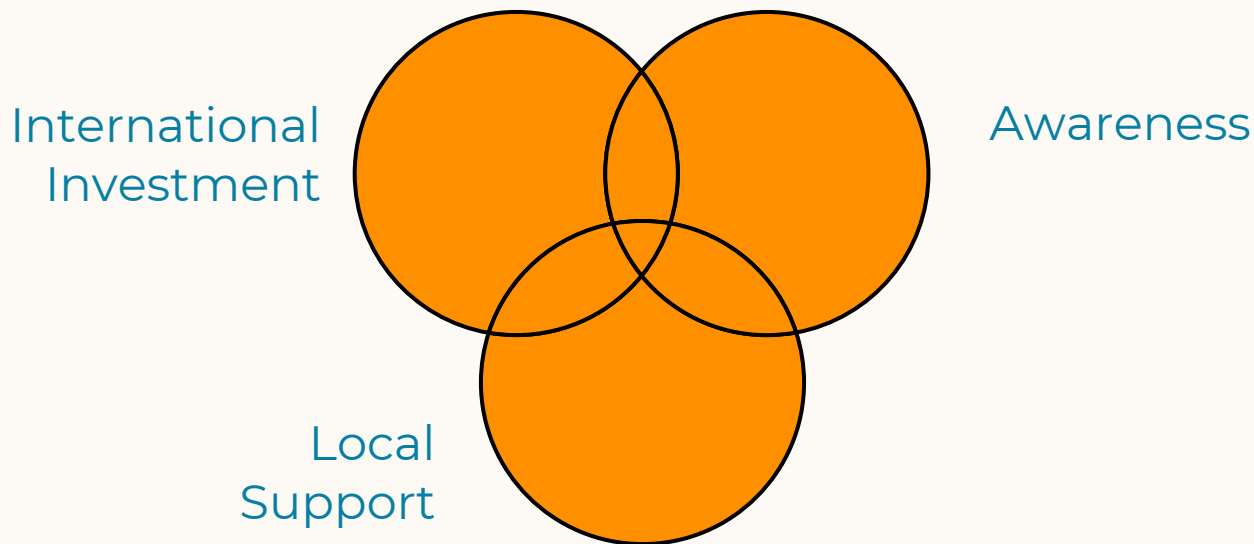


Cerrejón Open Pit Coal Mine

- Largest in the world
- Threatens Colombian water and territories
- Local and indigenous unrest as residents seek to revoke mining license

Proposed Solutions

Three factors must be considered



Development banks offer lots of conditional cash

Triodos Investment Management

- Focused on impact investing
- DOESN'T focus on impact to society
- Goal: ROI on Social Issues

Inter-American Dev. Bank

- Focused on Latin American development
- Energy conditions compromise natl. security

World Bank

- Far more resources for mitigation (emissions) than adaptation (living with climate change)

Other suggestions from academia

Belize Example

2021 Belize Sovereign Debt Restructuring

Partner with an NGO or a UN organization to use this money to fund a local conservation project (e.g. Blue Bonds)

Annual Target

Commit to an annual fiscal target for sustainability expenditures in Colombia

Ask for financial help from high-emitting upper-middle-income countries

Environmental justice starts with local underlying issues

Antonio

- Educated Colombian islanders about importance of rare mangrove ecosystem in preventing flooding
- People shocked by difference removing "bags and bags of trash" made in environment

Emilia

- Recognizes "brain drain" from people seeking education, jobs, and political stability

Pablo

- "When you're worried about your paycheck, you're a lot less worried about climate change"

Local non-profits are critical partners

Name	Location	Purpose	Contact
Acción Climática	Bogotá DC, Columbia	Promotes the integration of climate change solutions and related strategies in businesses, communities, and governments.	comunicaciones@accionclimatica.net
Asociación Centro Nacional Salud, Ambiente y Trabajo	Bogotá DC, Colombia	Preserves the health of the environment and communities, and promotes sustainable development in Colombia	info@censat.org
Cámara Verde de Comercio	Bogotá DC, Colombia	Supports companies organizations and people committed to social and environmental wellbeing	info@camaraverde.org
The Nature Conservancy	Bogotá DC, Colombia	Works with governments, companies, and society to conserve them and demonstrate how infrastructure is an ally	colombia@tnc.org

Local non-profits are critical partners

Name	Location	Purpose	Contact
Caring for Columbia	New York, NY	Mobilizes resources between the donor community and top-quality foundations	contact@caringforcolombia.org
Nature and Culture International	Del Mar, CA	Ensures that ecosystems can support current and future generations	hello@natureandculture.org
Soydoy Foundation	Bogotá, Colombia	Works to improve food security and agroecology	info@soydoy.org
Fundación Low Carbon City	Medellin, Colombia	Educates citizens around climate change and the solutions needed	lowcarbontv@gmail.com

SEED x FinMango Next Steps

A.

Connect research concretely to FinMango's Migration Trend Scanner

B.

Contact Colombian non-profits and conduct an awareness campaign

C.

More intensive economic analysis of issues revealed in this study

D.

Expand "case-study" style research to new cities in South America

Questions?

Additional resources

- Environmental Justice Storytelling Project
- Mining in Colombia
- Violations Against Colombian Peasants
- Debt and Climate Academic Research
- Cloud to Street
- Colombia Protests
- El Tiempo - Water Rationing
- Climate Adaptation
- Climate Promise